Task Sheet No. 11:
TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

INSTRUCTION:

As a pre-service teacher, you are tasked to write a **Teaching Philosophy Essay** that articulates your beliefs, values, and principles about teaching and learning. In your essay, discuss your view of the role of the teacher and learners, how learning takes place, the importance of creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment, and the teaching strategies you believe are most effective. Connect your beliefs to your observations and personal experiences during your Field Study 1 and 2, and relevant educational theories or principles, and explain how these beliefs will guide your future teaching practice. Your essay should be clear, reflective, well-organized, and grounded in your developing professional identity as future educator.

RUBRIC FOR GRADING:

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	PROFICIENT	DEVELOPING	BEGINNING
Teaching and Learning Beliefs (25%)	Clearly and thoughtfully articulates well-developed beliefs about teaching and learning, supported by relevant educational principles or theories.	Clearly presents relevant beliefs about teaching and learning with some connection to educational principles.	Presents general beliefs but provides limited explanation or connection to educational principles.	Provides unclear, limited, or unsupported beliefs about teaching and learning.
Role of Teacher and Learners (25%)	Provides a clear and insightful discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners and their relationship in the learning process.	Clearly discusses the roles of the teacher and learners with appropriate explanation.	Discusses the roles of the teacher and learners but with limited depth or clarity.	Provides minimal or unclear discussion of the roles of the teacher and learners.
Application to Practice Teaching (25%)	Clearly explains how the philosophy will guide specific teaching practices, classroom decisions, and interactions with diverse learners.	Explains how the philosophy can guide future teaching practice with relevant examples.	Provides general connections to future teaching practice with limited examples.	Makes little or no connection between the philosophy and future teaching practice.
Reflection and Professional Identity (25%)	Demonstrates deep self-reflection and clearly connects personal experiences and insights to the development of a professional teaching identity.	Demonstrates thoughtful reflection and makes relevant connections to professional growth.	Includes some reflection but connections to professional identity are limited.	Shows little evidence of reflection or developing professional identity.

MY TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

NAME OF PRE-SERVICE TEACHER: John Rex B. Duran

TITLE: Teaching Beyond Knowledge: Inspiring Students to Discover Their Potential

I believe that teaching is more than transferring knowledge from a teacher to students. It is about inspiring learners to discover their abilities, develop their confidence, and recognize their own potential. As a future educator, I want to become a teacher who believes in every student's capacity to learn and grow. I believe that every student has their own skills and talents, but sometimes they need encouragement and guidance to recognize what they are capable of achieving. For me, one of the greatest purposes of teaching is to help students believe in themselves and give them opportunities to reach their full potential.

I believe that students learn best when they are given the freedom to explore, experience new things, and learn from their mistakes. Making mistakes is a natural part of learning, and students should not feel afraid or embarrassed when they make them. Instead, they should understand that mistakes are opportunities to improve and become better. I want my future classroom to be a place where students feel comfortable trying new things, asking questions, and facing challenges. I believe that students grow when they are willing to step outside their comfort zones and embrace unfamiliar experiences. This belief is connected to constructivism, which explains that learners actively build their understanding through experiences and interactions rather than simply receiving information from their teachers.

As a teacher, I see myself primarily as a mentor who encourages and supports students throughout their learning journey. I want my students to feel that someone believes in their skills and talents, especially during moments when they doubt themselves. However, I also believe that teachers should not always provide students with the answers immediately. Instead, teachers should guide them through thoughtful questions that encourage critical and logical thinking. I want to ask questions that lead students toward discovering the answers on their own rather than spoon-feeding the main ideas. This approach reflects Socratic questioning, where teachers use meaningful questions to help learners examine ideas, develop reasoning, and reach their own conclusions. Meanwhile, I believe students should be open to new experiences, accept challenges, and take an active part in their own development. They should not limit themselves to what they already know because learning also happens when they explore what is unfamiliar.

Creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment is also an important part of my teaching philosophy. I believe that students can express their full potential when they feel safe, accepted, and respected. I want to build a classroom where students can freely share their thoughts, ideas, interests, and talents without being afraid of judgment. Students have different personalities, abilities, and levels of confidence, so I believe teachers should respect these differences and give everyone opportunities to participate. I also want to recognize students' small achievements because even simple improvements can encourage them to keep moving forward. When students struggle, I want to remind them that mistakes are normal and that they do not have to be perfect to make progress. I believe that providing guidance and encouragement can help reduce the pressure students feel and give them the confidence to continue learning.

My experiences during Field Study 1 helped shape these beliefs. During my classroom observations in Grade 7 TLE-FCS, I observed how my cooperating teacher used Canva presentations, a Smart TV, and a lapel microphone to support the lesson discussion. One thing I learned was the importance of asking questions to encourage students to participate. Through classroom discussions and oral questions, students were given opportunities to share their understanding and express their ideas. I realized that asking questions should not only test what students remember but should also encourage them to think deeper and explain their answers. I also observed differences in the attentiveness and engagement of students between the two sections. This helped me understand that students do not always respond to lessons in the same way, and teachers should continue finding ways to encourage their participation.

My experiences during Field Study 2 further strengthened my beliefs. As an assistant to my cooperating teacher, I had opportunities to help with classroom discussions and activities in Grade 7. One of my most meaningful experiences was seeing students become encouraged to recite and answer my questions by expressing their own ideas. It made me feel that I was fulfilling my purpose as a future teacher because I was not only sharing knowledge but also facilitating an exchange of ideas and learning. I realized that teaching is a two-way process. While teachers guide students and share their knowledge, they can also learn from the students' answers, experiences, and perspectives. This experience made me appreciate the importance of giving learners opportunities to express themselves rather than simply listening to their teachers.

In my future teaching practice, I want to prioritize hands-on learning and project-based learning, especially because my specialization is Computer Programming. I believe that students should have opportunities to apply the knowledge and skills they acquire through actual activities and projects. Learning programming, for example, should not be limited to memorizing concepts or understanding code examples. Students should also write programs, test their codes, identify errors, and develop their own projects. This reflects John Dewey's principle of learning by doing, which emphasizes the importance of experience in education. I want my students to understand that theoretical knowledge becomes more meaningful when they can apply it in practical situations. Through these activities, they can develop problem-solving skills, creativity, independence, and confidence in their abilities.

I also recognize that teaching is a continuous learning process and carries a great responsibility. Teachers are role models who can influence the values, attitudes, and decisions of their students. The way teachers communicate, treat others, and respond to challenges can leave a lasting impression on learners. Because of this, I want to practice patience, fairness, respect, and understanding in my future classroom. I also want to remain open to learning from my students and improving my teaching strategies based on their needs and experiences. My Field Study experiences have helped me realize that becoming a good teacher does not happen overnight. It requires continuous learning, reflection, and a willingness to improve.

Ultimately, I want my students to remember me as a teacher who believed in them, even when they had difficulty believing in themselves. I want them to recognize their own potential, appreciate their skills and talents, and become confident individuals who are willing to face challenges. I hope to become a meaningful part of their journey and someone who helped them realize what they are capable of achieving. However, I also want them to understand that their success belongs to them because of their own efforts, decisions, and determination. As a future educator, my goal is not only to teach lessons but also to inspire students to discover themselves, believe in their abilities, and continue growing beyond the classroom. For me, that is what makes teaching meaningful.